Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 6 — Reading • 2 min
- Artwork Spotlight: Katy Grannan's Portraits — Reading • 2 min
- Katy Grannan on Taking Portraits — Video • 3 min

Part II: Between Subject and Object
- Exploring Agency — Reading • 4 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Susan Meiselas on Carnival Strippers, 1973–75 — Video • 5 min
- Self-Possession — Reading • 4 min

Part III: Individuals and Types
- Performing Identity — Reading • 7 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Akram Zaatari on After They Got the Right to Arms. Fourteen young men posing with guns, early 1970s/2006 — Video • 6 min
- Hear More: Stephanie Syjuco on Cargo Cults, 2013–16 — Video • 2 min

Part IV: Strangers and Friends
- Loved Ones — Reading • 7 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Tina Barney on Sunday New York Times, 1982 — Video • 1 min
- Hear More: Deana Lawson on Rosie and Raquel, 2010 — Video • 1 min
- Hear More: Maria Antelman on Puzzlers, 2020 — Video • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges — Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Loved Ones

0:04 / 6:25 1x

Helen Levitt



Helen Levitt. *New York*. 1940. Gelatin silver print, 6 1/2 × 8 7/8" (16.6 × 22.5 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. David H. McAlpin Fund. © 2020 Film Documents LLC

With a small handheld camera, Helen Levitt recorded scenes on the streets of New York City. Children were one of the most common subjects of her work, and her photographs showed them playing games, drawing with chalk on the sidewalk, or in the case of this image from 1940, engaging in roleplay through the use of masks. Her work has been celebrated for its tender depictions of everyday life and its ability to convey the relationships that defined the close-knit neighborhoods of the city.

Harry Callahan



Harry Callahan. Left: *Eleanor*. c. 1947. Gelatin silver print, 4 9/16 × 3 7/16" (11.6 × 9.1 cm). Acquired with matching funds from the Joseph G. Mayer Foundation, Inc. and the National Endowment for the Arts; right: *Eleanor, Aix-en-Provence, France*. 1958. Gelatin silver print, 6 1/2 × 5 1/8" (16.6 × 13 cm). Gift of Robert and Joyce Menschel. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Both © 2020 The Estate of Harry Callahan

Harry Callahan taught at the New Bauhaus, later renamed Institute of Design, Chicago, from 1946 to 1961 and applied the experimental impulse of its pedagogy to his own photographic process. Turning his camera on his wife, Eleanor, he investigated a number of technically challenging approaches, including double exposures created by rewinding the film in camera. Callahan often combined tightly framed or cropped images with high contrast, reducing Eleanor's image or figure to a study of abstract forms in light or shadow.

Alfredo Cortina



Alfredo Cortina. *Camino a Carayaca*. 1953. Gelatin silver print, printed 2013, 12 7/8 × 8 1/2" (31.6 × 21.6 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Herman Siftones through the Latin American and Caribbean Fund

Alfredo Cortina took hundreds of photographs of his wife, poet Elizabeth Schön, in various environs around Venezuela in the 1950s and 1960s. In almost all the images, Schön appears alone in the middle-distance, and rarely looks into the camera lens or smiles. With backdrops such as a dusty roadside, a beach strewn with driftwood, and a commercial storefront, this group of images serves a portrait of Venezuela as a country, and it is clear that a project of this size required dedication on both sides of the camera.

Tina Barney



Tina Barney. *Sunday New York Times*. 1982. Chromogenic color print, 47 7/8 × 60 3/8" (121.6 × 153.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Anonymous gift. © 2020 Tina Barney

Tina Barney uses a large-format view camera on a tripod to photograph the people closest to her, including her family. From the beginning of her career, Barney focused on themes like family and ritual: "I wanted the pictures to be about affectionate gestures of the human body, what people wore, how they interact with each other in their domestic surroundings." In *Sunday New York Times*, the artist worked not with her own family, but one that was renting her neighbor's house. What she liked best about her new subjects was their ability to ignore the camera, allowing her to achieve the candid nature of a snapshot from a more choreographed process. For Barney, the most remarkable thing about photography is its ability to let us see ourselves and others in a more sincere way. "When we look at ourselves in the mirror, we can't really see what we look like," she said. "The only way to examine ourselves, or the history of our lives, is through photography."

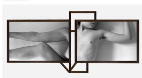
Deana Lawson



Deana Lawson. *Rosie and Raquel, New Orleans, Louisiana*. 2010. Pigmented inkjet print, 34 3/4 × 43 5/8" (88.3 × 110.8 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Deana Lawson

Deana Lawson refers to the subjects of her photographs as "her family." Although she is not related to them by blood—in fact, they are nearly all strangers—the pictures are remarkably intimate. Lawson composes almost every element, often sketching scenes out on paper before working with the camera. Reflecting Western and African portraiture conventions, the works examine "the body's ability to channel personal and social histories, drawing on the various formal and informal languages of the medium and its archival capabilities," the artist says. The result is an alphabet of body compositions demonstrating humans' seemingly limitless variety. The size of these photographs ensures that although they are intimate, they are also confrontational; viewers are invited into the world they depict, but strictly as spectators.

Maria Antelman



Maria Antelman. *Puzzlers V*. 2020. Pigmented inkjet print, wooden frame structure, 63 x 30" (160 x 76.2 cm). Courtesy the artist and Melanie Flood Projects, Portland, OR. © 2020 Maria Antelman

The beings in Maria Antelman's artworks are fashioned from images of isolated hands, limbs, heads, or eyes. Each work is a built structure of distinct elements that have been welded together with wooden frames to create a new image. For example, in *Puzzlers V*, Antelman combines a picture of her son's torso and left arm with a picture of her right arm, leg, and breast. In combining these distinct images, Antelman also obscures information, asking the viewer to fill in what lies in the between. Because she often photographs herself and her close family members, each of the human elements in her work is intimately familiar to her. As a result, works like *Puzzlers II* not only embody Antelman's relationship to her loved ones, they also function as portraits of herself. As Maria Antelman stated, using her children for these works "was the closest I could get to a self-portrait before I even made a self-portrait ever. It was like an extension…the closest version of myself."

Mark as completed

Like Dislike Report an issue